

JAMES HARRINGTON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years of experience building and scaling backend systems, primarily in fintech and e-commerce sectors. I've spent the last 6 years focused on distributed systems architecture and mentoring mid-level engineers through complex technical problems. My approach combines hands-on coding with strategic thinking about system design, and I genuinely enjoy helping teams navigate technical decisions that matter to the business.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer - QuantumScale Solutions

www.quantumscale.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the architectural redesign of our core transaction processing system, reducing latency by 65% and increasing throughput capacity from 2,000 to 15,000 requests per second while maintaining zero-downtime deployments.

Mentored 8 mid-level engineers on distributed systems principles, code review practices, and system design decision-making, with 3 of them promoted to senior positions within 18 months.

Established our internal platform engineering team from scratch, building abstractions and tools that reduced deployment friction for application teams and shortened release cycles from weekly to daily deployments.

Drove migration of legacy monolithic payment processor to microservices architecture, overseeing the effort across 6 engineering squads over 18 months with zero customer-facing incidents.

Senior Software Engineer - CreditFlow Ltd

www.creditflow.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Designed and implemented a real-time anti-fraud detection system processing 50 million daily transactions, resulting in 34% reduction in fraudulent transactions and saving the company GBP 2.8 million annually.

Owned backend services for customer onboarding platform serving 2 million active users, managing database optimization efforts that reduced query response times from 800ms to 120ms.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, achieving 99.95% uptime SLA and reducing mean time to incident resolution from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Collaborated with product and compliance teams to design and deliver regulatory reporting features meeting FCA requirements for 5 consecutive audit cycles with zero findings.

Senior Software Engineer - Nexus Digital Services

www.nexusdigital.net

London, United Kingdom

August 2010 - May 2017

Built high-performance REST APIs serving 100+ million requests daily for e-commerce platform, optimizing database queries and caching strategies to support Black Friday traffic spikes of 8x normal load.

Developed comprehensive internal documentation and runbooks for incident response, reducing knowledge silos and enabling on-call engineers to resolve production issues independently 80% of the time.

Worked across infrastructure and application teams to implement containerization strategy using Docker and Kubernetes, modernizing deployment pipeline and enabling faster iteration cycles for product teams.

Mentored 4 junior developers in software engineering fundamentals, system design principles, and professional development, with all 4 progressing to mid-level engineer positions.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, JavaScript, SQL

Backend Technologies: Microservices, gRPC, REST APIs, Apache Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, MongoDB

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, monitoring and observability

Distributed Systems: CAP theorem, eventual consistency, distributed transactions, system design patterns

Tools and Platforms: Git, Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, Jenkins, Linux

Methodologies: Agile, code review, technical documentation, incident management